

June 30, 2026

ClinicalTrials.gov
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Informed Consent Form

Study Title: A Pilot Study to Evaluate the Effectiveness of Focused Massage on Pain, Mobility, and Quality of Life During Radiation Treatment for Patients With Breast Cancer

Document Date: June 24, 2026
NCT07447700

Attached is the IRB approved informed consent.

Sincerely,

Beth Steinberg, PhD, RN
Primary Investigator

The Ohio State University Combined Consent to Participate in Research and HIPAA Research Authorization

Study Title:

A Pilot Study to Evaluate the Effectiveness of Focused Massage
on Pain, Mobility, and Quality of Life During Radiation
Treatment for Patients with Breast Cancer

Principal Investigator: Beth Steinberg, PhD, RN

Sponsor: None

- **This is a consent form for research participation.** It contains important information about this study and what to expect if you decide to participate. Please consider the information carefully. Feel free to discuss the study with your friends and family and to ask questions before making your decision whether or not to participate.
- **Your participation is voluntary.** You may refuse to participate in this study. If you decide to take part in the study, you may leave the study at any time. No matter what decision you make, there will be no penalty to you and you will not lose any of your usual benefits. Your decision will not affect your future relationship with The Ohio State University. If you are a student or employee at Ohio State, your decision will not affect your grades or employment status.
- **You may or may not benefit as a result of participating in this study.** Also, as explained below, your participation may result in unintended or harmful effects for you that may be minor or may be serious depending on the nature of the research.
- **You will be provided with any new information that develops during the study that may affect your decision whether or not to continue to participate.** If you decide to participate, you will be asked to sign this form and will receive a copy of the form. You are being asked to consider participating in this study for the reasons explained below.

Key Information About This Study

The following is a short summary to help you decide whether or not to be a part of this study. More detailed information is listed later in this form.

Patients with breast cancer who undergo radiation treatments can experience muscle and joint aches, discomfort, and tension in their arms, shoulders, neck, and upper back due to the positioning they must be in during treatment. The purpose of this study is to assess the effectiveness of focused upper body massages (provided while you are sitting in a massage chair) available after radiation treatments, on muscle and/or joint aches, musculoskeletal symptoms of the upper extremities (upper back, shoulders, neck, arms, and hands), and quality of life. The study will also assess the need and/or frequency for re-simulation during

your radiation treatment, that is, the need to re-image and mark your body and change how you are positioned for your radiation treatments. We will also check your perceptions of the acceptability of the massages offered during the course of your radiation treatments. The upper body massages will be provided by licensed massage therapists, with special training in oncology massage, who work at the OSU Center for Integrative Health. You can choose to have a massage after each radiation treatment, during the full course of your radiation treatments. Each massage will last up to 20 minutes and will be offered at the Stefanie Spielman Comprehensive Breast Center in a private space near where your radiation treatments occur. You will remain fully clothed during your massage. The study team will work with the James Patient Schedulers to coordinate the massages with your radiation treatments.

1. Why is this study being done?

This study is being done to assess if a brief massage of the upper back, shoulders, neck, arms, and hands, provided after radiation treatments, can help decrease any muscle and/or joint achiness, and discomfort you may experience after radiation treatments. The study will also assess if receiving the massages will prevent the need for re-simulation or changing your positioning during your radiation treatments. Lastly, the study will assess your perceptions of the massages that you received during your radiation treatments.

2. How many people will take part in this study?

We will recruit 55 patients who have been diagnosed with breast cancer and who are undergoing radiation treatments at Stephanie Spielman Comprehensive Breast Center.

3. What will happen if I take part in this study?

If you take part in the study, you will first complete some brief questionnaires that ask about muscle and/or joint achiness, any symptoms or physical issues with your upper back, neck, shoulders, arms and hands, and your health-related quality of life. These questionnaires will take about 30 minutes to complete. The study team will then work with the James Patient Schedulers to coordinate the massages with your radiation treatments. You can choose to have the massages after each radiation treatment during the course of your radiation treatments. The massages are scheduled to accommodate your preferences, your physical and emotional health, and personal schedule. If there are some days that you cannot integrate a massage into your treatment day, you can still participate in the study.

Each week at your weekly treatment appointment, you will complete the brief questionnaires about muscle and/or joint achiness, any symptoms or physical issues with your upper back, neck, shoulders, arms and hands. These questionnaires will take about 15 minutes to complete.

At your post-treatment 4-6 week appointment, you will again complete the brief questionnaires about muscle and/or joint achiness, any symptoms or physical issues with your upper back, neck, shoulders, arms and hands, and your health-related quality of life. We will also have you complete a 4-question survey about your perceptions about the massages you received. You will also be asked to respond to two brief open-ended question about your experience with the massages you received after your radiation treatments. These questionnaires will take about 30 minutes to complete. Time completing study related questionnaires will be based on how many weeks your radiation treatments last; the total time may range from 2 hours to 3 hours over the course of your time in the study.

Your radiation treatments are physician directed and may be scheduled daily, every other day (3 times a week), or twice weekly. Participation in the massage intervention (30 minutes per session includes 20 minutes in the massage room, 10 minutes to change to/from the robe used during radiation treatment) may range from 2 hours (1 radiation treatment per week for 4 weeks) to 9 hours (3 radiation treatments per week for 6 weeks). Based on the frequency and length of your prescribed radiation treatments, the total time that you may spend completing questionnaires and receiving the massages may range from 4 hours to 12 hours.

4. How long will I be in the study?

You will be in the study as long as your radiation treatments are scheduled.

5. Can I stop being in the study?

You may leave the study at any time. If you decide to stop participating in the study, there will be no penalty to you, and you will not lose any benefits to which you are otherwise entitled. Your decision will not affect your future relationship with The Ohio State University.

6. What risks, side effects or discomforts can I expect from being in the study?

The massage intervention, while intended to provide relief of discomfort and relaxation, may cause increased discomfort and stress. Because the intervention is conveniently provided at the Stefanie Spielman Comprehensive Breast Center, the same place as you receive your radiation treatments, it is possible that other clinical staff and other patients may know that you are participating in a research study. Breach of confidentiality of data is always risk, however, all precautions to maintain the security and confidentiality of your information security will be taken.

7. What benefits can I expect from being in the study?

We anticipate that the massage intervention will bring physical relief and improved well-being to participants in the study. Supportive interventions, such as a focused chair massage, that can easily be scheduled along with your radiation treatment plan may help patients with

breast cancer manage the physical and emotional symptoms they may experience during the course of treatment and recovery.

8. What other choices do I have if I do not take part in the study?

You may choose not to participate without penalty or loss of benefits to which you are otherwise entitled.

9. What are the costs of taking part in this study?

There are no costs to participate in this study.

10. Will I be paid for taking part in this study?

Participants will not be paid for taking part in this study.

11. What happens if I am injured because I took part in this study?

If you suffer an injury from participating in this study, you should notify the researcher or study doctor immediately, who will determine if you should obtain medical treatment at The Ohio State University Wexner Medical Center.

The cost for this treatment will be billed to you or your medical or hospital insurance. The Ohio State University has no funds set aside for the payment of health care expenses for this study.

12. What are my rights if I take part in this study?

If you choose to participate in the study, you may discontinue participation at any time without penalty or loss of benefits. By signing this form, you do not give up any personal legal rights you may have as a participant in this study.

You will be provided with any new information that develops during the course of the research that may affect your decision whether or not to continue participation in the study.

You may refuse to participate in this study without penalty or loss of benefits to which you are otherwise entitled.

An Institutional Review Board responsible for human subjects research at The Ohio State University reviewed this research project and found it to be acceptable, according to applicable state and federal regulations and University policies designed to protect the rights and welfare of research participants.

13. Will my de-identified information be used or shared for future research?

Yes, it/they may be used or shared with other researchers without your additional informed consent.

14. Will my study-related information be kept confidential?

Efforts will be made to keep your study-related information confidential. However, there may be circumstances where this information must be released. For example, personal information regarding your participation in this study may be disclosed if required by state law.

We will work to make sure that no one sees your survey responses without approval. But, because we are using the Internet, there is a chance that someone could access your online responses without permission. In some cases, this information could be used to identify you.

Also, your records may be reviewed by the following groups (as applicable to the research):

- Office for Human Research Protections or other federal, state, or international regulatory agencies;
- U.S. Food and Drug Administration;
- The Ohio State University Institutional Review Board or Office of Responsible Research Practices;
- The sponsor supporting the study, their agents or study monitors; and
- Your insurance company (if charges are billed to insurance).

A description of this clinical trial will be available on <http://www.ClinicalTrials.gov>, as required by U.S. law. This website will not include information that can identify you. At most, the website will include a summary of the results. You can search the website at any time.

15. HIPAA AUTHORIZATION TO USE AND DISCLOSE INFORMATION FOR RESEARCH PURPOSES

I. What information may be used and given to others?

- Past and present medical records;
- Research records;
- Records about phone calls made as part of this research;
- Records about your study visits;
- Information that includes personal identifiers, such as your name, or a number associated with you as an individual;
- Information gathered for this research about:
Survey questionnaires

II. Who may use and give out information about you?

Researchers and study staff.

III. Who might get this information?

- The sponsor of this research. “Sponsor” means any persons or companies that are:
 - working for or with the sponsor; or
 - owned by the sponsor.
- Authorized Ohio State University staff not involved in the study may be aware that you are participating in a research study and have access to your information;
- If this study is related to your medical care, your study-related information may be placed in your permanent hospital, clinic, or physician’s office record;

IV. Your information may be given to:

- The U.S. Food and Drug Administration (FDA), Department of Health and Human Services (DHHS) agencies, and other federal and state entities;
- Governmental agencies in other countries;
- Governmental agencies to whom certain diseases (reportable diseases) must be reported; and
- The Ohio State University units involved in managing and approving the research study including the Office of Research and the Office of Responsible Research Practices.

V. Why will this information be used and/or given to others?

- To do the research;
- To study the results; and
- To make sure that the research was done right.

VI. When will my permission end?

There is no date at which your permission ends. Your information will be used indefinitely. This is because the information used and created during the study may be analyzed for many years, and it is not possible to know when this will be complete.

VII. May I withdraw or revoke (cancel) my permission?

Yes. Your authorization will be good for the time period indicated above unless you change your mind and revoke it in writing. You may withdraw or take away your permission to use and disclose your health information at any time. You do this by sending written notice to the researchers. If you withdraw your permission, you will not be able to stay in this study. When you withdraw your permission, no new health information identifying you will be gathered after that date. Information that has already been gathered may still be used and given to others.

VIII. What if I decide not to give permission to use and give out my health information?

Then you will not be able to be in this research study and receive research-related treatment. However, if you are being treated as a patient here, you will still be able to receive care.

IX. Is my health information protected after it has been given to others?

There is a risk that your information will be given to others without your permission. Any information that is shared may no longer be protected by federal privacy rules.

X. May I review or copy my information?

Signing this authorization also means that you may not be able to see or copy your study-related information until the study is completed.

16. Who can answer my questions about the study?

For study questions, concerns, or complaints, to withdraw consent and HIPAA authorization, or if you feel you have been harmed as a result of study participation, you may contact Beth Steinberg, PhD, RN at beth.steinberg@osumc.edu or 614-406-7067.

For questions related to your privacy rights under HIPAA or related to this research authorization, please contact HIPAA Privacy Officer, Suite E2140, 600 Ackerman Road, Columbus, OH 43201; privacyoffice@osumc.edu. Or 614-293-4477.

For questions about your rights as a participant in this study or to discuss other study-related concerns or complaints with someone who is not part of the research team, you may contact the Office of Responsible Research Practices at 1-800-678-6251.

If you are injured as a result of participating in this study or for questions about a study-related injury, you may contact Beth Steinberg, PhD, RN at beth.steinberg@osumc.edu or 614-406-7067.

**CONSENT &
AUTHORIZATION**

IRB Protocol Number: STUDY20251037

IRB Approval date: 6-24-2026

Version: 2.0

Signing the consent form

I have read (or someone has read to me) this form and I am aware that I am being asked to participate in a research study. I have had the opportunity to ask questions and have had them answered to my satisfaction. I voluntarily agree to participate in this study.

I am not giving up any legal rights by signing this form. I will be given a copy of this combined consent and HIPAA research authorization form.

Printed name of participant

Signature of participant

Date and time AM/PM

Printed name of person authorized to consent for
participant (when applicable)

Signature of person authorized to consent for participant
(when applicable)

Date and time AM/PM

Relationship to the participant

Investigator/Research Staff

I have explained the research to the participant or his/her representative before requesting the signature(s) above. There are no blanks in this document. A copy of this form has been given to the participant or his/her representative.

Printed name of person obtaining consent

Signature of person obtaining consent

Date and time AM/PM

Witness(es) - *May be left blank if not required by the IRB*

Printed name of witness

Signature of witness

Date and time AM/PM

Printed name of witness

Signature of witness

Date and time AM/PM